



BEYOND THE GATE

ANCIENT ORDER OF FREE GARDENERS

PERSONAL GROWTH

Through consistent effort and mindful cultivation, we nurture our inner landscapes, pulling out the weeds of doubt and negativity, and planting seeds of growth, positivity, and wisdom. Just as a garden flourishes with care and attention, so too do we thrive when we commit to personal development and self-awareness.

WHO WE ARE

In a world where the pace of life is ever accelerating, finding a sense of community and purpose can be a transformative experience. One unique avenue for cultivating such connections is through the Order of Free Gardeners, a fraternal organization with roots deeply embedded in the mysteries of metaphorical gardening.

Joining this organization offers an invaluable opportunity to connect with like-minded people, creating a supportive network that extends beyond the lodge



HISTORY

Founded in Scotland almost 400 years ago as a trade society for operative gardeners, the Free Gardeners expanded to welcome men from diverse backgrounds and professions. The Order experienced a revival in 2002, infusing its ancient traditions with the modern world. The influx of new members has brought fresh ideas and viewpoints, keeping the Order contemporary and significant in the present era. The Free Gardeners aim to cultivate wisdom, empathy, and solidarity, fostering a vibrant community that blossoms with each changing season.

WANT TO LEARN MORE? VISIT US



AFFILIATIONS

Throughout the history of Free Gardeners there have been independent lodges (not affiliated with any Grand Lodge) as well as multiple Grand lodges. These bodies coincided in harmony, each one respecting the other and each with their unique ritual and traditional differences. We continue in this spirit of harmony today. In addition to the independent lodges, there are affiliations such as the Grand United Order of Free Gardeners (Australia); Order of Free Gardeners (South Africa); The International Order of Free Gardeners (England); The Free Gardeners Grand Lodge (Germany); and The Ancient Order of Free Gardeners (North America).

OUR HERITAGE

The Free Gardeners established a grand lodge in North America on July 10, 1876, with the founding of the United States Grand Lodge of the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners. While we have yet to determine when this Grand Lodge ceased operations, we did discover records of another U.S. affiliation known as the Independent Order of Free Gardeners in Maryland, dating back to 1852. Additionally, there is documentation of a charter granted to a lodge in Brooklyn, NY, by the St. Andrews Order of Ancient Free Gardeners. The decision to revert to the name Ancient Order of Free Gardeners was made in Canada during a meeting of members who would later form the North America Grand Lodge of the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners.

HOW TO JOIN?

Joining the Ancient Order of Free Gardeners begins with a personal choice. The initial step is to submit an application. After your application is received, you will be invited to an interview where both members and applicants can meet and ask questions.

If there isn't a local lodge in your area and you're interested in starting one, you should first apply and complete the necessary degrees before requesting authorization to invite others to join your prospective lodge. Once you have gathered 3 to 8 potential members, you can submit a petition to receive a charter for the lodge.